

Edinburgh - Leading the Way in Artificial Intelligence Innovation

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rtificial Intelligence technology is becoming an increasingly common part of our everyday lives. The

thriving Edinburgh Tech Hub is making it all happen right here in Scotland.

Why Edinburgh?

Edinburgh was the first in Scotland to embrace the innovation hub concept: bringing people from different types of organisations together to work on the same theme in the same space. Unsurprisingly, Edinburgh has one of the greatest tech talent pools in the world, attracting talent-hungry companies to set up in Scotland.

From a Research Idea to Your Doorstep

The University of Edinburgh is UK's oldest AI research centre. Today it is one of the best in the world. The University, with its excellent facilities, attracts the best talent from well over 100 countries.

Skyscanner, now a leading travel search platform, is a spin-out from the University of Edinburgh. Some of the University's research on autonomous systems and explainable AI feeds directly into the Five AI technology – a driverless cars company that has recently launched a trial of its shared autonomous car fleet in London. The University of Edinburgh is a member of the ORCA (Offshore Robotics for Certification of Assets) Hub, a research consortium exploring robotics and AI for the offshore sector. One of the robots developed at ORCA is ANYmal, an autonomous four-legged robot designed for extreme environments. Weighing 30kg and operating up to a 10kg sensor payload, its flexible joints allow it to inspect areas that humans and other robots



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Dr Jasmina Lazic,
Chief Data Technologist
Bayes Centre, the University
of Edinburgh

find difficult to reach. In October 2018, ANYmal was deployed on a North Sea oil rig platform, making it the world's first offshore robot to successfully complete an autonomous platform inspection.

A Thriving AI Start-up scene

In April 2018, with London Tech Week in full swing, the UK Government announced the launch of the AI and Blockchain Accelerator in Edinburgh. The Accelerator was launched to support high-growth potential start-ups that help drive the economic growth, create jobs, and provide seed investment in Scotland and across UK.

The first group of companies successfully raised £3 million at £12.5m valuation before the end of the pro-

gramme. Their work was showcased at the Wayra AI & Blockchain Demo Day earlier this month. From smart cities and health to satellites and digital content, the applications of AI were truly fascinating. Ever wondered what happens to those photos you post on Instagram? Is anyone using them? A start-up company called Edjo has built an AI-driven platform to track and monetise plagiarised digital content. Mental health? There is an app for that! Voxsio has developed a personal mental health AI assistant that empowers you to measure and improve your mental well-being. ABAKA is an award-winning Cognitive Financial Advice platform that delivers conversational AI technology offering affordable advice on personal savings, pensions and investments. The demonstrated potential of AI to profoundly transform our lives is truly eye-opening.

Another big mover and shaker in the Edinburgh AI start-up scene is the Engage Invest Exploit (EIE) conference. This is a flagship event run by the University of Edinburgh's Informatics Ventures, a technology investor showcase featuring Scotland's most promising, data-driven high growth companies which are seeking funding. With 900 delegates, including 240 investors from all over the world, the 11th EIE event held on 24th of April was bigger than ever before. A great exhibition of splendid ideas, with themes ranging from digital health and digital forensics, to intelligent advertising and financial regulations.

Don't Miss Out, Get Involved!

If you want to be a part of our vibrant, collaborative community and work with us, please get in touch with Bayes Centre, Edinburgh Innovations, or Edinburgh Parallel Computing Centre. [d](#)